

RESPECT THE MAT. ■



1

STEP ON, STEP OFF

Pause or bow at the edge of the mat.
Shoes stay off it, always.

2

COME READY

Clean gi, short nails, hair tied back,
no jewellery.

3

LISTEN FIRST

When your coach speaks, eyes up
and conversation down.

4

EVERY BELT, EVERY BODY

Train with everyone. Nobody is too
new, or too senior, to learn from.

5

LEAVE THE EGO AT THE DOOR

No gloating when you win. No
excuses when you lose.

6

THANK YOUR PARTNER

A handshake or fist bump before and
after every round.

**Everyone on this mat was a beginner
once.**

TAP EARLY. TAP OFTEN.

A tap is information, not a defeat. Your joints have to last longer than any single round.

FOUR WAYS TO TAP, ALL OF THEM COUNT

1

Tap twice with your hand on your partner, the mat or yourself.

2

Arms trapped? Tap the mat twice with your foot.

3

Say it out loud: “tap” or “stop”.

4

Any cry or sound of pain also ends it.

IF YOU ARE CAUGHT

Tap before it hurts, not after.

Tap when you cannot escape. You lose nothing by learning.

Tap, then breathe. You will be back at it next round.

IF YOUR PARTNER TAPS

Let go the instant you feel or hear it. Not “almost”. Now.

Apply every submission slowly. Never crank.

Once released, check they are OK.

TAP MEANS LET GO. ALWAYS.

KNOW THE RULES.

Competition rules by age and belt, from the IBJJF Rules Book v6.1 (June 2024).
Use them as a guide for class. Your coach decides what is allowed in yours.

MATCH TIME, IN MINUTES

YOUTH DIVISION	AGE	MIN	ADULT AND MASTERS	WHITE	BLUE	PURPLE	BROWN	BLACK
Mighty Mite	4–6	2	Adult 18+	5	6	7	8	10
Pee Wee	7–9	3	Master 1 (30+)	5	5	6	6	6
Junior	10–12	4	Masters 2–7 (36+)	5	5	5	5	5
Teen	13–15	4						
Juvenile	16–17	5						

Age is this year minus birth year. Final matches run double time. The lowest belt’s time applies when belts are mixed.

WHAT IS LEGAL, GI, ADULT DIVISIONS

TECHNIQUE	WHITE BELT	BLUE · PURPLE	BROWN · BLACK
Straight ankle lock	Legal	Legal	Legal
Wrist lock	Illegal	Legal	Legal
Bicep slicer · Calf slicer	Illegal	Illegal	Legal
Knee bar	Illegal	Illegal	Legal
Toe hold	Illegal	Illegal	Legal
Heel hook · Knee reaping	Illegal	Illegal	Illegal
Jump to closed guard	Illegal	Legal	Legal
Slams · Spinal locks · Knee-twisting locks	Illegal	Illegal	Illegal

Juvenile 16–17 follows the white belt column for submissions. Ages 4–15 are stricter still, and jumping to closed guard is illegal for every belt under 15. See the IBJJF Technical Fouls poster for the move-by-move list.

POINTS, AFTER 3 SECONDS OF CONTROL

2 Takedown	2 Sweep	2 Knee on belly	3 Guard pass	4 Mount	4 Back control
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